

Your First 3 Steps

A CALM MONEY MONTH STARTS WITH THREE SMALL MOVES

STEP 1

Write down what comes in

Add up one month of take-home pay (after tax) and side income. Put it in the Income box on the budget page.

STEP 2

List every bill

Rent, utilities, phone, insurance, loans, subscriptions. Note the due date and tick each one off as you pay it.

STEP 3

Give every dollar a job

Plan each category until “Left to assign” is $0 (savings count as a job). At month end, fill in Actual and compare.

Tip: do this on paper first. One honest month of numbers beats a perfect plan you never start.

Monthly Budget

GIVE EVERY DOLLAR A JOB: PLANNED VS. ACTUAL

MONTH _____ **INCOME** _____ **PLANNED SPENDING** _____ **LEFT TO ASSIGN** _____

Category	Planned	Actual	Difference	Notes
Housing				
Utilities				
Groceries				
Transportation				
Insurance				
Debt payments				
Savings				
Personal care				
Kids				
Pets				
Subscriptions				
Giving				
Fun & dining out				
Gifts				
Other				
Total				

Zero-based budgeting: income minus planned spending (savings included) should leave $0 to assign.



Bill Payment Checklist

YEAR _____

Bill	Due	Amount	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
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Tip: list bills in due-date order and tick each box the day you pay it. A bill still unticked after its due date is the one to call about.



READY FOR MORE?

The full PlanWellHome money toolkit

This starter is part of a bigger set of budget printables and spreadsheets. Every one is an instant download you can print at home or fill in on your computer.

Budget Binder	16 printable pages: goals, income, budget, bills, envelopes, savings, debt, net worth
Bills & Budget Binder Bundle	the binder plus a bill tracker spreadsheet with a due-date calendar
Debt Snowball Tracker	your debt-free date, snowball or avalanche, in Excel and Google Sheets
Sinking Funds Tracker	save a little each month for the big costs you know are coming
Money Reset 2027	a fresh-start budget, net worth and goals bundle for the new year
Savings Challenges	52-week, envelope and no-spend challenges to color in

YOUR NEXT STEP

- [ ] Fill in this month's budget, then put it where you'll see it
- [ ] Tick off each bill the day you pay it
- [ ] At month end, write down one thing that surprised you

Find them all: search PlanWellHome on Etsy

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